

Kosovo

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** February 18, 2008 **Usage:** National and Civil

Blue and yellow are from the European Union Flag. White is for peace



Six stars are for the six communities in Kosovo

Golden map of county outline on a blue field

Europe



Formerly part of Yugoslavia and then Serbia, **Kosovo** came under United Nations administration in 1999. Kosovo declared independence in February, 2008.

In 1459, the Ottoman Turks destroyed the first Serbian kingdom in a battle in modern Kosovo. Although the country was ceded to Serbia in 1913, the majority of Kosovars are Albanian in language and culture, but the site of the battle is sacred to the Serbs.

When Yugoslavia broke apart in the 1990s, many Kosovans hoped that they

would unite with Albania. Serbia opposed this idea. In 1999, violence flared between Kosovars and Serbs. NATO forces intervened to stop Serbian attacks. In the uneasy peace which followed, there were negotiations under the United Nations. These failed and in 2008 Kosovo controversially declared its independence.

ARMS OF KOSOVO

The arms is a shield in the same design as the flag

